IC3 GS5 Computing Fundamentals

Vocabulary Flashcards

75 glossary terms (corrected) + 8 bonus terms = 83 cards, 8 per sheet.

HOW TO PRINT

1. Print pages 2 to the end DOUBLE-SIDED, 'flip on long edge.'
   Odd pages = TERMS (fronts). Even pages = DEFINITIONS (backs), already mirrored to line up.
2. Use cardstock if you can. Check one sheet first to make sure fronts and backs line up.
3. Cut along the dashed lines.

Can't print double-sided? Print single-sided, cut, and glue/tape each
front to its back. Each card shows a matching number (#) on both sides.

HOW TO STUDY

- Look at the term, say the meaning out loud, then flip. Make a 'Got it' pile and a 'Not yet' pile.
- The unit tag on each card shows which lesson it belongs to.
- 5 minutes a day beats 1 hour the night before.

CORRECTIONS FROM THE ORIGINAL GLOSSARY

- JPG supports 24-bit color (not 4-bit).
- IPv6 addresses use hexadecimal groups separated by colons (not dotted decimal).
- Bandwidth (networking) = data-transfer capacity per second.

Unit 5 #1

.avi

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Unit 5 #2

.doc

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Unit 5 #3

.docx

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Unit 4 #4

.exe

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Unit 5 #5

.jpg

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Unit 5 #6

.mp3

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Unit 5 #7

.mp4

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Unit 5 #8

.pdf

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.doc #2

The older Microsoft Word document format (Word 97-2003).

If someone with very old Word can't open your file, save it as .doc.

.avi #1

Audio Video Interleave. An older Microsoft video file format that holds video and sound together.

Old camcorder clips are often .avi. Some phones won't play them without a different app.

.exe #4

An executable file: a Windows program that runs or installs software when you open it.

Never open an .exe that came in an email you weren't expecting. It could be malware.

.docx #3

The current Microsoft Word document format (Word 2007 and newer). Smaller and more modern than .doc.

Most resumes you upload to job sites are .docx or .pdf.

.mp3 #6

A compressed audio file. Small enough to store thousands of songs.

Podcasts and downloaded songs are often .mp3.

.jpg #5

JPEG image. A compressed photo format that supports 24-bit color (about 16.7 million colors). It shrinks files by dropping some detail (lossy).

Phone photos you text or post are usually .jpg.

.pdf #8

Portable Document Format. Looks exactly the same on any device, so it's great for forms and resumes.

Save your resume as a PDF so the formatting doesn't move around.

.mp4 #7

A very common video file format (video + audio) that plays on almost any device.

Videos you record on most phones or download are usually .mp4.

Unit 5 #9

.swf

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Unit 5 #10

.tif

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Unit 5 #11

.txt

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Unit 5 #12

.wav

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Unit 5 #13

.xls

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Unit 5 #14

.xlsx

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Unit 5 #15

.zip

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Unit 3 #16

Android

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.tif #10

Tagged Image File Format (.tif or .tiff). A high-quality image format, often used for scanning and printing. Files are large.

Scanners often offer TIFF for archive-quality copies.

.swf #9

Shockwave Flash file: Adobe Flash animation or game. Flash was shut down at the end of 2020, so browsers no longer play .swf files.

Still on the exam: .swf = Adobe Flash.

.wav #12

An uncompressed audio file. High quality but much larger than .mp3.

Voice recordings for editing are often .wav.

.txt #11

A plain text file. Just letters and numbers, no bold, colors, or pictures.

Notepad saves .txt files.

.xlsx #14

The current Microsoft Excel spreadsheet format (Excel 2007 and newer).

A shift schedule or budget made in Excel today is .xlsx.

.xls #13

The older Microsoft Excel spreadsheet format (Excel 97-2003).

Older budget templates may still be .xls.

Android #16

Google's mobile operating system, built on Linux and open source. Used by Samsung, Google Pixel, Motorola, and many other brands.

Apps come from the Google Play Store.

.zip #15

A compressed archive file that packs one or more files into one smaller file.

Zip a folder of 10 scanned pages to email them as one attachment.

Unit 8

#17

Antivirus Application

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Unit 2

#18

Bandwidth

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Unit 8

#19

Browser History

IC3 GS5 Computing Fundamentals

Unit 8

#20

Cache

IC3 GS5 Computing Fundamentals

Unit 3

#21

Cellular Data

IC3 GS5 Computing Fundamentals

Unit 2

#22

Cellular Network

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Unit 7

#23

Cloud Access

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Unit 6

#24

Cloud Storage

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Bandwidth #18

In networking, the maximum amount of data a connection can move in a set amount of time, usually measured in Mbps or Gbps. More bandwidth = more data at once.

A 300 Mbps home plan can stream on more devices at once than a 25 Mbps plan.

Antivirus Application #17

Software that scans for, blocks, and removes viruses and other malware. It needs regular updates to recognize new threats.

Windows includes Microsoft Defender Antivirus for free.

Cache #20

Copies of web page parts (images, scripts) your browser saves so pages load faster next time.

Clearing the cache can fix a page that won't load right.

Browser History #19

The list of websites you have visited in a web browser.

Clear it after using a library computer.

Cellular Network #22

A network of cell towers, each covering an area called a 'cell,' that carriers use for calls, texts, and mobile data.

Your call is handed from tower to tower as the bus moves across the borough.

Cellular Data #21

Internet access through your phone carrier's cell network. It usually counts against your plan's data.

Streaming video on the train with no Wi-Fi uses cellular data.

Cloud Storage #24

Saving files on a company's remote servers (Google Drive, OneDrive, iCloud, Dropbox) instead of only on your own device.

If your phone is lost, photos in cloud storage are still safe.

Cloud Access #23

Using apps, files, and services over the Internet from any device, instead of from one computer.

Open your Google Doc at the library, then finish it on your phone.

Unit 8

#25

Cookie

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Unit 4

#26

Check Box

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Unit 1

#27

Driver

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Unit 4

#28

Drop-Down Menu

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Unit 2

#29

Ethernet

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Unit 8

#30

Firewall

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Unit 4

#31

Firmware

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Unit 1

#32

Hardware

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Check Box #26

A small square option in a menu or form. You can select as many check boxes as you want.

'Select all that apply' questions use check boxes.

Cookie #25

A small file a website saves in your browser to remember you (logins, shopping carts, settings). Some cookies track you across sites.

That's why a site 'remembers' what's in your cart.

Drop-Down Menu #28

A list that opens when you click it, letting you choose one option.

Choosing your state on a job application form.

Driver #27

Software that lets the operating system talk to a piece of hardware, like a printer or graphics card.

A new printer may need its driver installed before it will print.

Firewall #30

Hardware or software that watches network traffic and blocks or allows it based on rules.

Windows has a built-in firewall you can adjust.

Ethernet #29

The standard for wired networks. Uses network cables with RJ-45 plugs (they look like a wide phone plug).

Plugging a desktop straight into the router with a cable is an Ethernet connection.

Hardware #32

The physical parts of a computer or device you can touch.

Keyboard, screen, RAM chips, hard drive.

Firmware #31

Software stored permanently on a hardware device that controls its basic functions (for example, BIOS/UEFI on a PC or the software inside a router).

Routers get firmware updates to fix security holes.

Unit 1

#33

HDMI

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Unit 3

#34

iOS

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Unit 2

#35

IPv4

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Unit 2

#36

IPv4 Address

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Unit 2

#37

IPv6

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Unit 2

#38

IPv6 Address

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Unit 1

#39

Keyboard Shortcut

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Unit 1

#40

Laptop

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iOS #34

Apple's operating system for the iPhone. (iPads use iPadOS, which is closely related.)

Apps come from the Apple App Store.

HDMI #33

High-Definition Multimedia Interface. A digital port and cable that carries HD video AND audio together.

Connect a laptop to a TV with one HDMI cable.

IPv4 Address #36

An address written as four decimal numbers from 0 to 255, separated by dots.

Example: 192.168.1.25

IPv4 #35

Internet Protocol version 4. Uses 32-bit addresses, which allows about 4.3 billion addresses. That's not enough for today's devices.

Still the most common type you'll see on a home network.

IPv6 Address #38

An address written as eight groups of four hexadecimal digits (0-9, a-f), separated by colons. Groups of zeros can be shortened with ::.

Example: 2001:0db8:85a3:0000:0000:8a2e:0370:7334

IPv6 #37

Internet Protocol version 6. Uses 128-bit addresses, which allows a practically unlimited number. It was created because IPv4 addresses ran out.

Many phones and ISPs already use IPv6.

Laptop #40

A portable computer with a built-in screen, keyboard, touchpad, and battery.

A Chromebook is a type of laptop.

Keyboard Shortcut #39

A combination of keys that runs a command without using the mouse.

Ctrl+C copy, Ctrl+V paste, Ctrl+Z undo, Windows+L lock.

Unit 4

#41

Linux

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Unit 7

#42

LMS

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Unit 4

#43

Local App

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Unit 6

#44

Malware

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Unit 1

#45

Memory

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Unit 3

#46

MMS

IC3 GS5 Computing Fundamentals

Unit 2

#47

Modem

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Unit 8

#48

Monitoring Software

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LMS #42

Learning Management System. Software that delivers online courses, gives assignments and tests, and tracks student progress.

Google Classroom, Canvas, Blackboard, Moodle.

Linux #41

A free, open-source operating system that anyone can use and change. Comes in many versions (distributions) such as Ubuntu. Runs most web servers.

Android is built on Linux.

Malware #44

Malicious software. The umbrella term for any software designed to harm, spy on, or take control of a device (viruses, Trojans, ransomware, spyware).

Local App #43

An app installed on your device. It runs from your device, often works offline, and uses your device's storage.

Microsoft Word installed on a PC.

MMS #46

Multimedia Messaging Service. Text messages that include pictures, video, audio, or group texts.

Sending a photo of your pay stub by text uses MMS.

Memory #45

Usually means RAM: the computer's short-term working space. It is volatile, so it's erased when power is off. More RAM lets you run more programs at once. (Long-term storage is the drive.)

8 GB of RAM is a common minimum for a Windows PC today.

Monitoring Software #48

Software that records what a person does on a device (websites, keystrokes, screen, location). Used by employers and parents, and also by attackers (spyware).

Assume work computers may be monitored.

Modem #47

The device that connects your home to your Internet Service Provider (ISP). It converts the ISP's signal (cable, DSL, fiber) into digital data your devices can use.

Many ISPs give you one box that is a modem + router combo.

Unit 1

#49

Mouse

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Unit 4

#50

OS

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Unit 1

#51

PC

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Unit 1

#52

Peripherals

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Unit 3

#53

Permissions

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Unit 4

#54

Radio Button

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Unit 8

#55

Ransomware

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Unit 2

#56

Router

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OS #50

Operating System. The main software that manages all the hardware and software on a device and lets you use it.

Windows, macOS, Linux, iOS, Android, ChromeOS.

Mouse #49

A handheld pointing device used to move the pointer and click on the screen.

Peripherals #52

External devices you connect to a computer to add input, output, or storage.

Keyboard, mouse, printer, webcam, external drive, speakers.

PC #51

Personal Computer. Often used to mean a computer running Windows (as opposed to a Mac).

Radio Button #54

A small round option in a group. You can pick only ONE choice from the group.

Choosing 'Full-time' OR 'Part-time' on an application.

Permissions #53

Settings that control who can view, change, or delete a file or folder, or what an app is allowed to use (camera, location, contacts).

Read-only vs. Read/Write; 'Allow this app to use your location?'

Router #56

A device that directs data between networks, such as your home network and the Internet. Most home routers also create the Wi-Fi network.

Ransomware #55

Malware that locks or encrypts your files and demands payment to unlock them.

Backups are the best protection.

Unit 7

#57

SaaS

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Unit 5

#58

Scanning

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Unit 2

#59

Secure Network

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Unit 1

#60

Server

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Unit 3

#61

SMS

IC3 GS5 Computing Fundamentals

Unit 8

#62

Social Engineering

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Unit 3

#63

Text Messaging

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Unit 8

#64

Trojan Horse

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Scanning #58

Turning a paper document or photo into a digital file using a scanner or a phone camera app. (Also: an antivirus 'scan' checks files for malware.)

Scan your ID and pay stubs to upload for a housing application.

SaaS #57

Software as a Service. Software you use over the Internet, usually by subscription. The company hosts it, updates it, and stores the data.

Microsoft 365, Google Workspace, Salesforce, Zoom.

Server #60

A computer or program that accepts requests from other computers (clients) on a network and provides services or data back to them.

When you open a website, a web server sends you the page.

Secure Network #59

A network that requires a password or sign-in and encrypts traffic (for example, WPA2 or WPA3 Wi-Fi).

Social Engineering #62

Tricking people into giving up information, money, or access instead of hacking the computer. Phishing emails, scam texts, and fake tech-support calls are examples.

'Your E-ZPass toll is unpaid, click here' texts.

SMS #61

Short Message Service. Plain text messages of up to 160 characters sent over the cellular network.

Regular texts without pictures.

Trojan Horse #64

Malware disguised as a useful or harmless program. Unlike a virus, it doesn't copy itself; it tricks you into installing it.

A 'free movie player' download that installs spyware.

Text Messaging #63

Sending short written messages between phones or devices (SMS, MMS, iMessage, RCS).

Unit 6

#65

Troubleshooting

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Unit 8

#66

Unsecure Network

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Unit 1

#67

USB

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Unit 1

#68

VGA

IC3 GS5 Computing Fundamentals

Unit 8

#69

Virus

IC3 GS5 Computing Fundamentals

Unit 3

#70

VoIP

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Unit 8

#71

VPN

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Unit 7

#72

Web App

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Unsecure Network #66

An open network with no password or encryption, such as some public Wi-Fi. Others nearby may be able to see your traffic.

Don't do banking on open café Wi-Fi without a VPN.

Troubleshooting #65

A step-by-step process for figuring out what's wrong and fixing it.

Restart, check connections, read the error, search for it, test one change at a time.

VGA #68

Video Graphics Array. An older analog video-only port (usually blue, 15 pins) for monitors and projectors. It does not carry audio.

Old classroom projectors may still use VGA.

USB #67

Universal Serial Bus. The standard port for connecting and charging devices. USB-A is the older rectangle; USB-C is the newer small oval that plugs in either way.

Flash drives, keyboards, phone chargers.

VoIP #70

Voice over Internet Protocol. Making phone or video calls over the Internet instead of the regular phone network.

WhatsApp calls, Google Voice, Microsoft Teams calls.

Virus #69

Malicious code attached to a file or program. It spreads when the infected file is opened or run, and it can erase, corrupt, or steal data.

Web App #72

An app that runs inside a web browser, with nothing to install. Needs an Internet connection (mostly).

Gmail, Google Docs, Outlook on the web.

VPN #71

Virtual Private Network. Creates an encrypted 'tunnel' between your device and a VPN server, protecting your data on public networks or letting you securely reach a work network.

Unit 2

#73

Wi-Fi

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Unit 2

#74

Wireless

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Unit 5

#75

Zip File

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Bonus

#76

Phishing

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Bonus

#77

Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA)

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Bonus

#78

Hotspot

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Bonus

#79

Spyware

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Bonus

#80

Plug-in

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Wireless #74

Connecting without cables. Includes Wi-Fi, Bluetooth, and cellular.

Wi-Fi #73

Wireless networking technology that connects devices to a router using radio waves.

Free Wi-Fi at NYPL, BPL, and Queens Public Library branches.

Phishing #76

A social engineering scam using fake emails, texts (smishing), or calls (vishing) to steal passwords, money, or personal info.

Zip File #75

A compressed file (.zip) that bundles one or more files into a smaller package for easier sharing or storage. You 'extract' (unzip) it to use the files.

Hotspot #78

Using a phone's cellular data to share an Internet connection with other devices over Wi-Fi.

Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) #77

Signing in with two or more proofs, such as a password plus a code sent to your phone. Also called 2-step verification.

Plug-in #80

A small piece of software that adds a feature to an application, like a browser.

Spyware #79

Malware that secretly watches what you do and sends the information to someone else.

Bonus

#81

Open Source

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Bonus

#82

Bluetooth

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Bonus

#83

Backup

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Bluetooth #82

Short-range wireless technology for connecting nearby devices like earbuds, speakers, and keyboards.

Open Source #81

Software whose code is public, so anyone can use, study, change, and share it (Linux, Android).

Backup #83

An extra copy of your files kept somewhere else (external drive or cloud) so you can restore them if the originals are lost.